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# Tunisia's Used Car Market: A Data-Driven Analysis

*Insights on Pricing, Consumer Behavior, and Market Structure*

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**Data Sources:** Tayara.tn & Automobile.tn

## **Abstract**

This report presents a comprehensive, data-driven analysis of Tunisia's used car market, drawing on approximately 4,900 listings scraped from the two largest Tunisian automotive online marketplaces — *Tayara.tn* and *Automobile.tn* — during June, July, and August 2025. The dataset captures vehicle specifications, listed prices, geographic context, and derived features engineered through a multi-stage cleaning and imputation pipeline. The analysis reveals that the market is structurally dominated by European manufacturers, with Volkswagen holding the leading brand position at roughly 13% market share and an average listing price of 60,000 TND. Petrol-fuelled vehicles account for 70.3% of all listings, reflecting a policy and cost environment that systematically disadvantages diesel ownership. A pronounced affordability crisis emerges from the data: the median used car price stands at approximately 38,000 TND, equivalent to more than 26 months of Tunisia's average salary of 1,570 TND per month. Regional analysis confirms a strong spatial polarisation, with Grand Tunis alone accounting for nearly one-third of all transactions and concentrating the vast majority of luxury vehicle listings. Taken together, these findings paint a portrait of a market under structural pressure, in which rising prices, stagnant incomes, and inadequate public transport infrastructure create a captive and increasingly indebted consumer base, even as nascent but accelerating electric and hybrid vehicle adoption signals a longer-term structural transition.

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## 1. Introduction and Context

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### 1.1 Purpose and Motivation

The Tunisian used car market sits at the intersection of several important socioeconomic forces: stagnant real wages, persistent inflation, a weakened national currency, limited access to consumer credit, and a near absence of reliable urban public transport outside the capital. In this environment, the decision to purchase a vehicle is not merely a consumer preference but frequently an economic necessity — and the price at which that vehicle changes hands encodes a remarkable amount of information about the state of the broader economy. The primary purpose of this analysis is to decode that information: to translate raw marketplace data into actionable economic signals that can inform decisions by dealers, policymakers, investors, and prospective buyers alike.

More specifically, this report seeks to identify the dominant pricing dynamics, geographic patterns, and brand preferences that characterise the contemporary Tunisian used car market; to construct a profile of the average Tunisian buyer and the vehicle they are most likely to purchase; to examine how major historical shocks — particularly the 2011 Revolution and the COVID-19 pandemic — have left measurable traces in the market's structure; and to assess the early signs of a forthcoming transition toward electrified and hybridised mobility. Together, these objectives produce an integrated economic portrait of a market that holds greater macro-level diagnostic value than its modest size might initially suggest.

### 1.2 Dataset Description

The dataset was collected from two major Tunisian online automotive marketplaces: **Tayara.tn** and **Automobile.tn**. Data collection was conducted in July 2025, with listings spanning June, July, and August of the same year. The resulting dataset contains **4,900 records**, each representing a distinct vehicle listing and capturing a set of features that describe the car's key specifications, geographic context, and listed price. Scraped features include brand, model, manufacturing year, fuel type, transmission type, engine size, fiscal power, body type, mileage, listed price, and seller location (at the governorate level). Additional features — such as vehicle age, brand origin, and price category — were engineered during the data preparation phase.

Exploratory analysis of the raw data revealed several heavily skewed distributions, particularly in price and mileage. These skews are not artefacts of data quality issues but rather accurate reflections of real market structure: a large majority of listings cluster in the mid-range price tier, with a long tail of higher-priced luxury and premium vehicles that inflates the mean relative to the median. The dataset is therefore well-suited for both distributional analysis, which benefits from median-based statistics, and segmentation analysis, which benefits from the representativeness of the bulk of the distribution.

### 1.3 Data Collection and Processing Pipeline

Data was collected via custom-built scrapers developed specifically for each platform. The two scrapers operated differently due to the structural differences between the two websites: the Tayara.tn scraper faced greater challenges owing to the platform's inconsistent page structure and dynamic rendering, resulting in a somewhat lower extraction success rate for certain fields. The Automobile.tn scraper achieved higher completeness, particularly for structured numerical fields such as engine size and fiscal power.

The data preparation pipeline involved several sequential steps. First, obvious errors and duplicates were removed, and pricing outliers beyond the 99th percentile were filtered. Second, categorical features — particularly brand names, model names, fuel types, and geographic labels — were standardised through explicit mapping dictionaries to ensure consistency across the two datasets. Third, missing numerical values were imputed using machine-learning-based models where sufficient training data was available, with a fallback to median imputation for sparser fields. Fourth, both cleaned datasets were merged into a single unified table, the schema of which is described in Table 1. Throughout this pipeline, strict attention was paid to preserving the analytical integrity of the data: imputation decisions were logged and treated with appropriate caution in downstream interpretation.

**Table 1.** Summary of dataset schema and feature descriptions.

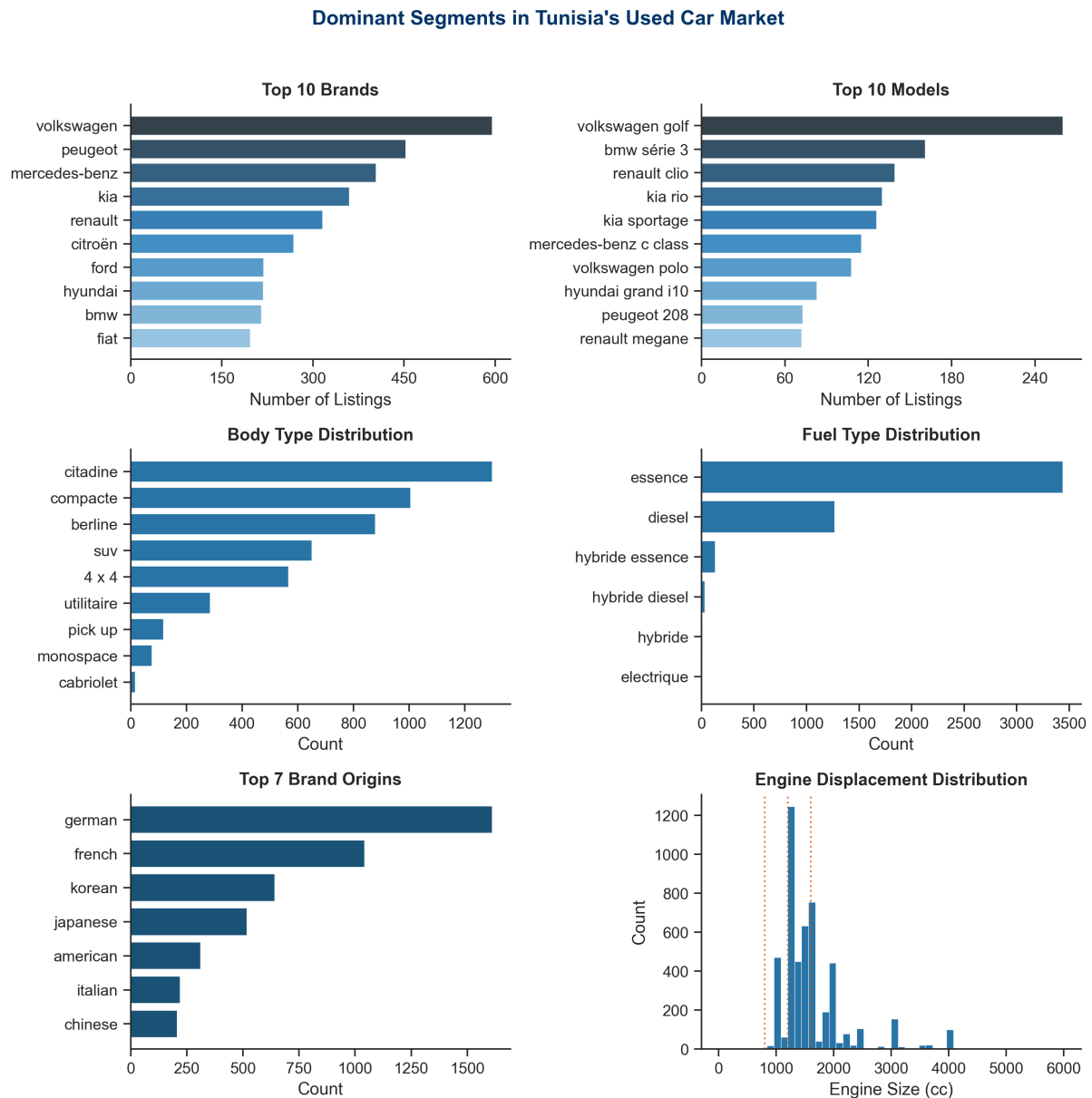
| Feature      | Type        | Description                                  |
|--------------|-------------|----------------------------------------------|
| price        | Numeric     | Listed price in Tunisian Dinar (TND)         |
| brand        | Categorical | Vehicle manufacturer                         |
| model        | Categorical | Model name                                   |
| year         | Numeric     | Registration year                            |
| fuel         | Categorical | Fuel type (petrol, diesel, electric, hybrid) |
| gear         | Categorical | Transmission (manual / automatic)            |
| engine-size  | Numeric     | Engine displacement in cc                    |
| fiscal-power | Numeric     | Fiscal horsepower (tax-linked HP)            |
| body-type    | Categorical | Body type (city car, saloon, SUV, etc.)      |
| mileage      | Numeric     | Odometer reading in km                       |
| location     | Categorical | Seller governorate                           |
| car-age      | Numeric     | Vehicle age in months (engineered)           |
| origin       | Categorical | Country/region of manufacture (engineered)   |

## 2. Market Overview and Composition

## 2.1 Dominant Brands and Models

The 2025 dataset reveals a used car market strongly shaped by European manufacturers. At the brand level, **Volkswagen** occupies the leading position, representing approximately **13% of all listings** at an average price of **60,000 TND**. It is followed by **Peugeot** and **Renault**, which together account for approximately **20%** of the market, and by **Mercedes-Benz** and **Kia** rounding out the top five. German automakers collectively account for close to **one-third of total listings**, while French and Korean brands occupy the next largest shares. This distribution reflects decades of import patterns and established dealer networks rather than a recent shift in consumer taste.

At the model level, the dominance of compact and city-class vehicles is unmistakable. The **Volkswagen Golf** is the single most listed model, maintaining strong demand across multiple generations up to the Golf 8, with an average listing price of **66,000 TND**. It is followed by the **BMW 3 Series** at an average of **80,000 TND** — a price level that reflects the model's premium positioning but also suggests relatively high turnover driven by expensive maintenance costs. The **Renault Clio** and **Kia Rio** occupy the third and fourth positions respectively, representing Tunisia's preferred city cars at average prices of **37,000 TND** and **51,000 TND**. The **Kia Sportage**, at an average of **90,000 TND**, stands as the dominant SUV in the used-vehicle segment. Chinese brands, though currently representing only approximately **4–5%** of the market, are increasingly visible and are widely expected to expand their share as more recently imported models enter the resale cycle.



**Figure 1.** Market overview: dominant brands, models, body types, fuel types, origins, and engine sizes.

## 2.2 Body Types and Engine Characteristics

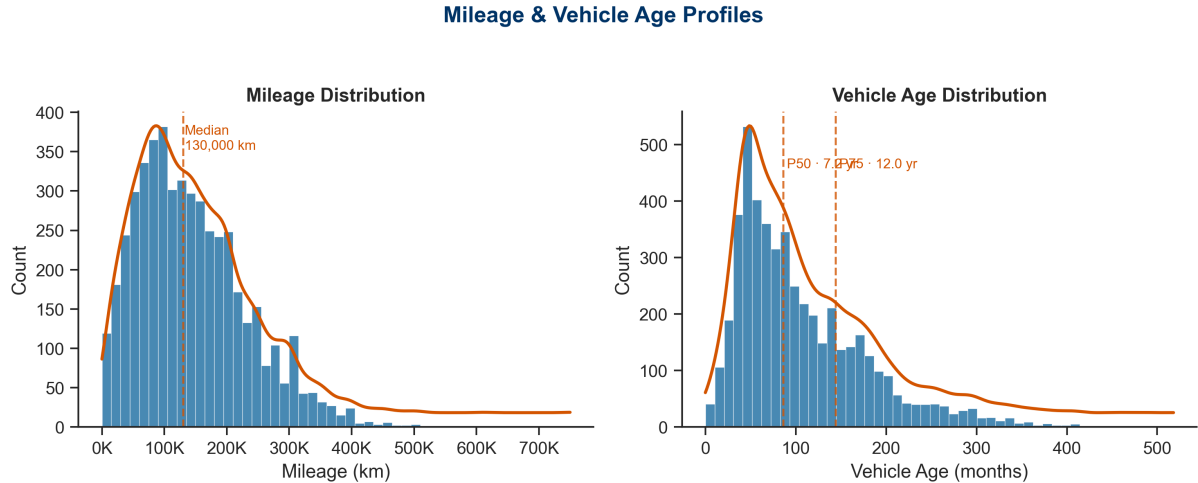
The body-type distribution confirms the overwhelmingly utilitarian character of the Tunisian used car market. **City cars** (*citadines*) are the single most frequent body type, reflecting strong consumer preference for compact, inexpensive-to-maintain, and easy-to-resell vehicles. Compact cars form the second largest segment, driven largely by the Volkswagen Golf and its counterparts. Together, city and compact vehicles account for roughly **half of all listings**, leaving SUVs, saloons, estates, and commercial vehicles to divide the remainder.

Analysis of engine size reveals a distinctive **bimodal distribution**, with the two dominant peaks located at approximately **1,200 cc** and **1,600 cc**. This pattern is a direct consequence



of the predominance of small-engined petrol vehicles, which minimise both acquisition cost and annual tax liability. Engine sizes above 2,000 cc appear at meaningfully lower frequencies, confirming that the high-performance and large-engine segment occupies a minor niche in a market primarily defined by economic pragmatism.

### 2.3 Mileage and Vehicle Age Profiles



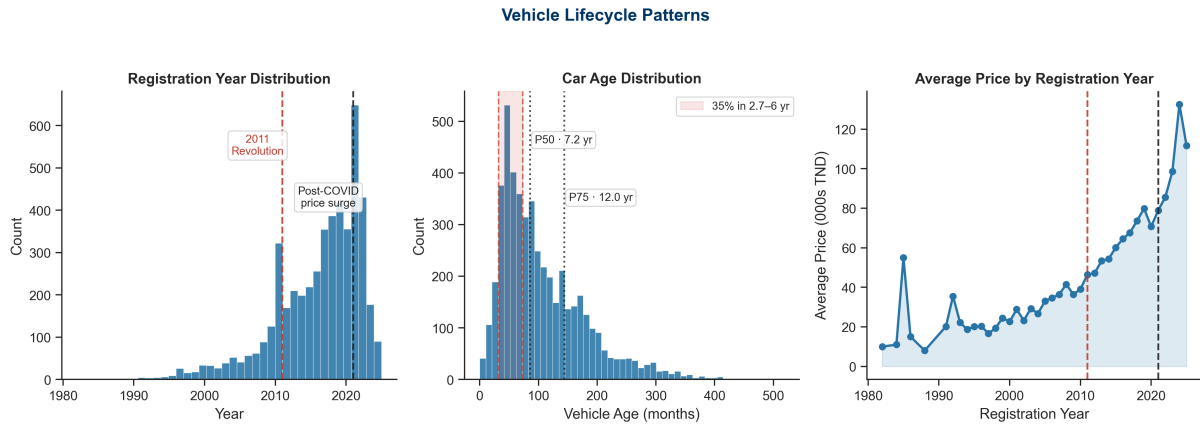
**Figure 2.** Mileage and vehicle age distributions.

The mileage distribution is **heavily right-skewed**, with the majority of vehicles falling in the range of **75,000 to 190,000 km** and the single most common observed cluster centred near **100,000 km**. Listings with very high mileage — above 300,000 km, for instance — are relatively uncommon, which may reflect a preference among sellers to transact before vehicles reach recorded levels that might substantially depress prices. The distribution also plausibly reflects the bulk resale of rental fleet vehicles, which are typically retired at moderate mileage levels after a few years of intensive use.

The vehicle age distribution mirrors this pattern with an additional feature: a moderate left tail reflecting a meaningful share of very recent listings. Approximately **50% of all listings involve vehicles under 7.2 years old**, and **75% of listings involve vehicles under 12 years old**. Frequencies decline sharply beyond this point. The **most common vehicle age is approximately four years**, accounting for around **40% of all listings** — a pattern indicative of a **dynamic resale cycle** in which Tunisian car owners turn over their vehicles at relatively short intervals compared to regional norms.

## 3. Vehicle Lifecycle Patterns and Historical Shocks

### 3.1 Registration Year Distribution



**Figure 3.** Vehicle lifecycle analysis: registration year distribution, age profile, and average price by model year.

The registration year distribution takes the form of a **left-skewed curve**, reflecting the structural reality that newer vehicles represent disproportionately large shares of available listings. The growing dominance of online marketplaces has made vehicle resale faster, more transparent, and more geographically accessible, compressing ownership cycles and accelerating turnover. Within the overall trend, however, two historical inflection points produce clearly visible breaks in the distribution.

The first corresponds to the **2011 Tunisian Revolution**. In the years preceding 2011, registration data shows a steady upward trend, consistent with a period of stable economic growth and sustained consumer confidence. Following the Revolution, the market experienced a **marked contraction**, driven by a combination of reduced import activity, currency depreciation, and the erosion of purchasing power under conditions of political and economic instability. Vehicle registrations dipped noticeably in the 2011–2013 window and only gradually recovered thereafter.

The second inflection point corresponds to the **end of COVID-19 lockdown restrictions** in late 2020 and 2021. Rather than producing a recovery plateau, the post-pandemic period is characterised by an **exponential acceleration** in average prices per registration year. This surge reflects the confluence of global inflationary pressures on new car manufacturing, supply chain disruptions that constrained the availability of new vehicles in the Tunisian market, a weakening Tunisian Dinar, and a domestic cost-of-living crisis that pushed many consumers who could not afford new cars toward the used market, thereby inflating demand and prices simultaneously.

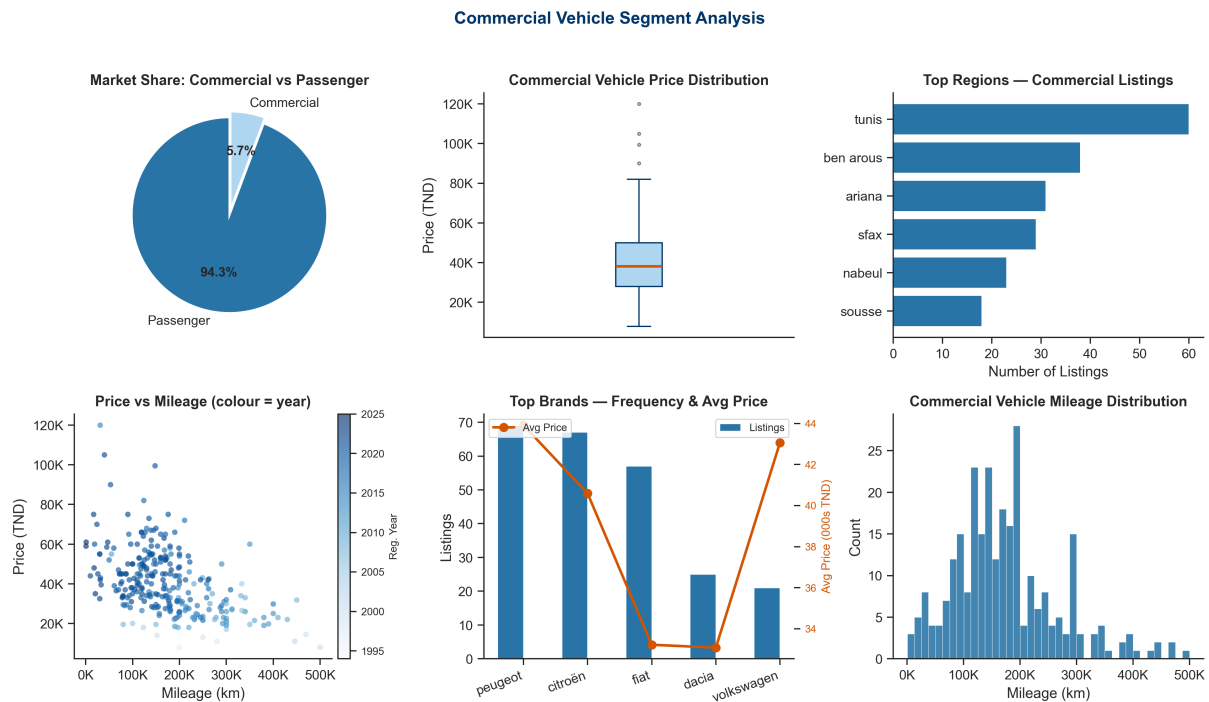
### 3.2 Ownership Cycles and the Car as an Asset

A notable feature of the data is that **approximately 40% of all listings fall within a sale window of 2.7 to 6 years of vehicle age**. This clustering suggests a structural

norm in which Tunisian car owners typically sell their vehicles after three to six years of ownership — a pattern that differs from many comparable developing markets where vehicles are held for longer. Several factors likely contribute to this behaviour. The steep post-2020 price appreciation has effectively transformed cars into **inflation hedges**: sellers who purchased vehicles before price escalation can often resell at a meaningful real gain after several years, reducing the effective cost of ownership and incentivising earlier resale. The growing availability and ease of use of online platforms has also lowered the transaction cost of resale, making shorter holding periods more economically rational. Looking forward, these dynamics are unlikely to reverse in the short term, and the used car market appears structurally set to maintain — or accelerate — this pattern of rapid turnover.

## 4. Commercial Vehicle Segment

### 4.1 Market Share and Pricing



**Figure 4.** Commercial vehicle segment analysis.

Commercial utility vehicles (*utilitaires*) account for approximately **5.7%** of all listings in the 2025 dataset. Their price distribution is **slightly right-skewed**, with most listings falling below **80,000 TND** and the interquartile range spanning approximately **27,000 to 55,000 TND**. The mean listing price for commercial vehicles is approximately **40,270 TND**. A typical commercial vehicle in the dataset is around **eight years old**, has recorded roughly **175,000 km**, carries a **1.6-litre engine**, and is priced near the segment average.

The mileage profile of the commercial vehicle segment reveals two prominent clusters: one centred around **200,000 km** and another near **300,000 km**. These clusters span multiple registration cohorts, suggesting that commercial vehicle use is intensive and that odometer levels are not reliably correlated with age — a pattern that may also partly reflect odometer tampering practices that are not uncommon in the Tunisian secondary market. Vehicles aged between **2016 and 2022** show the widest price dispersion within the segment, with some listings reaching above **120,000 TND** even at moderate mileage levels.

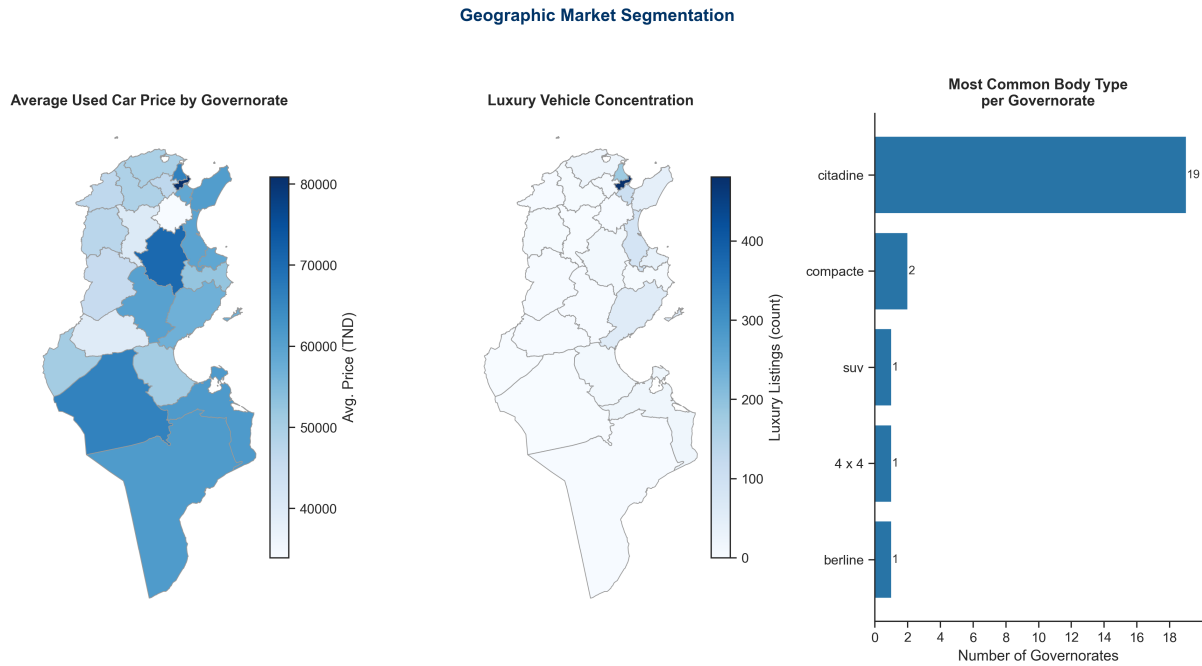
#### 4.2 Brand Leadership in the Commercial Segment

French manufacturers dominate the commercial segment, led by **Peugeot** and **Citroën**, which hold comparable market shares. Peugeot commercial vehicles average **44,000 TND**, while Citroën averages **40,600 TND**. **Fiat** occupies the more affordable end of the spectrum at approximately **33,000 TND**. The persistent dominance of French brands in this sub-segment is underpinned by their engines' reputation for reliability and fuel efficiency at moderately high mileage levels, combined with the easy availability of genuine and aftermarket spare parts through Tunisia's well-developed parallel parts market. Geographically, commercial vehicle activity is concentrated in economic hubs: **Grand Tunis**, **Sfax**, **Nabeul**, and **Sousse** collectively account for the majority of commercial listings, confirming these cities' roles as the primary nodes of commercial and logistics activity in the country.

### 5. Geographic Market Segmentation

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## 5.1 Regional Price Mapping



**Figure 5.** Geographic market segmentation: regional price levels, luxury vehicle concentration, and dominant body types.

The regional price distribution map reveals a systematic **price gradient**, with average listing prices increasing steadily from interior regions toward the coastal north. Overall, average prices across governorates range between approximately **35,000 and 80,000 TND**. The **northern and northeastern regions**, with Tunis at the apex, record the highest average prices in the country. Coastal cities of the Sahel — **Sousse, Monastir, and Sfax** — record average prices around **55,000 TND**, consistent with their position as secondary economic hubs with above-average household incomes and higher demand for more recent vehicle vintages.

Interior governorates tell a markedly different story. Cities such as **Kasserine, Siliana, and Gafsa** record the lowest average prices in the national dataset, reflecting both lower purchasing power and a higher prevalence of older, higher-mileage vehicles in local supply. Interestingly, the southern region maintains moderately elevated average prices, with **Kebili** recording the highest southern average at approximately **66,000 TND** — a finding consistent with the district's relative prosperity relative to its neighbours, driven by its role in the phosphate and tourism economies.

## 5.2 Luxury Vehicle Concentration

The distribution of luxury vehicle listings is highly polarised. **Grand Tunis alone accounts for 777 luxury model listings** — an overwhelming majority of the national total. **Sfax** and **Sousse** record notable luxury concentrations relative to their overall

market size, consistent with their status as Tunisia's second and third most economically productive urban centres. In stark contrast, interior governorates show an almost **complete absence** of luxury brand listings, confirming the spatial concentration of high-income households along the coastal strip.

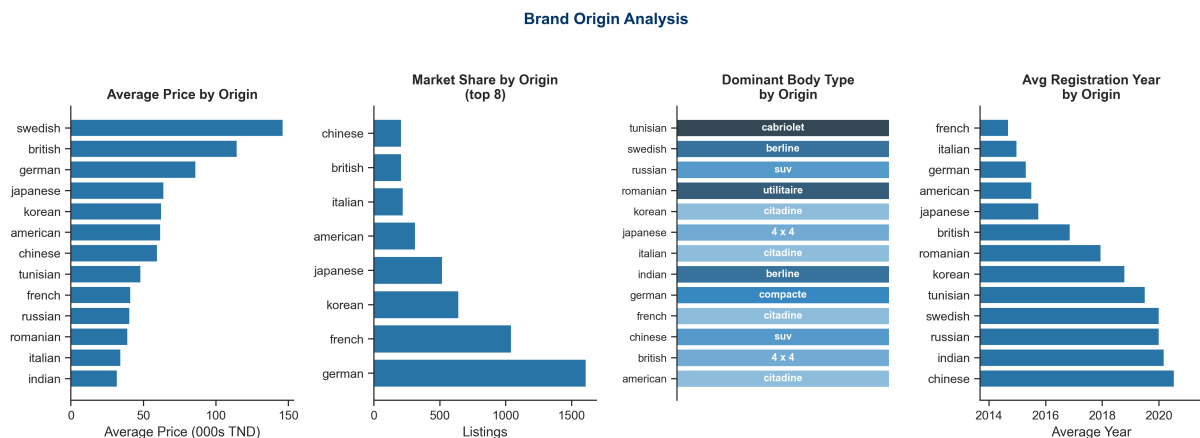
This spatial pattern is not merely descriptive but carries structural implications. The Tunisian wealth distribution is effectively mapped by luxury vehicle geography: business owners, executives, and high-income professionals are concentrated in Tunis and the major coastal cities, while the national market as a whole is shaped by middle- and working-class buyers who prioritise affordability and practicality. The national used car market, then, is in reality two partially overlapping markets superimposed on a single dataset: a mass-market segment driven by economic necessity, and a niche luxury segment driven by status-signalling and discretionary wealth.

### 5.3 Regional Body-Type Preferences

City cars dominate body-type preferences in **19 out of 24 Tunisian governorates** — a finding that reinforces the analysis of brand and model preferences described above. This near-universal preference for *citadines* reflects limited purchasing power, the low maintenance costs of small vehicles, and the ease of resaling compact cars in a liquid national market. Five governorates deviate from this pattern: in **Kebili**, for instance, 4×4 vehicles represent the dominant body type, likely reflecting the district's working conditions and the functional need for vehicles capable of handling unpaved roads and load-bearing tasks. Whether these deviations represent genuine demand preferences or artefacts of small sample sizes in interior governorates is a question worthy of further investigation.

## 6. Brand Origin Analysis and Consumer Preferences

### 6.1 Market Share by Country of Origin



**Figure 6.** Brand origin analysis: average price, market share, dominant body types, and market recency.

**German manufacturers** lead the Tunisian used car market with approximately **32% market share**, followed by **French automakers** at roughly **21%**. Together, European brands represent over **half of the national market**. Asian manufacturers hold the second largest collective share at approximately **23%**, driven by Korean (primarily Kia and Hyundai) and Japanese brands (notably Toyota and Isuzu), with Chinese makes accounting for approximately **4%** of total listings — a share that understates their near-term trajectory.

Within the pricing hierarchy, **Swedish cars** record the highest average value at over **140,000 TND**, driven almost entirely by the premium-only Volvo lineup. British brands (*Land Rover*, *Jaguar* and *MG*) rank second in average price, while German vehicles average **85,000 TND** — a figure that blends the premium segment (Mercedes, BMW, Audi, Porsche) with the mass-market segment (Volkswagen, Opel). Japanese and Korean brands cluster around **60,000 TND**, while French brands average approximately **40,000 TND**, confirming their positioning as the primary choice for middle-income buyers. This pricing hierarchy is summarised in Table 2.

**Table 2.** Average listing price and market share by brand origin.

| Brand Origin     | Avg. Price<br>(TND) | Approx. Market<br>Share |
|------------------|---------------------|-------------------------|
| Swedish (Volvo)  | >140,000            | <1%                     |
| British          | ~130,000            | ~2%                     |
| German           | ~85,000             | ~32%                    |
| Korean           | ~60,000             | ~13%                    |
| Japanese         | ~60,000             | ~10%                    |
| Chinese          | ~50,000             | ~4–5%                   |
| French           | ~40,000             | ~21%                    |
| Romanian (Dacia) | ~35,000             | ~3%                     |

## 6.2 Body-Type Preferences by Origin

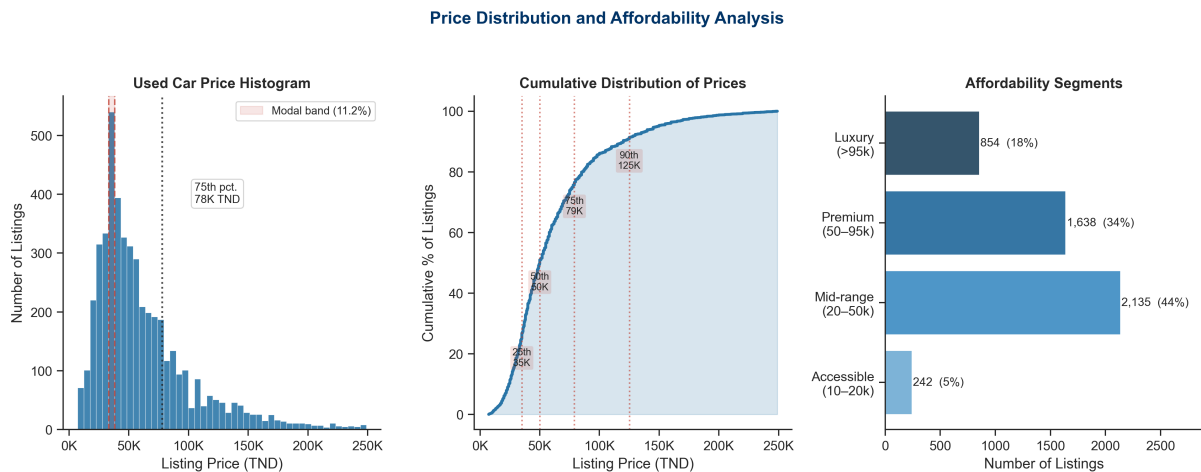
Body-type preferences are closely aligned with each origin's brand strategy. **German vehicles** are predominantly represented by **compact models**, consistent with the Golf's dominant position. **French and Korean brands** primarily offer city cars: the Peugeot 208, Renault Clio, and Hyundai i20 are emblematic of this positioning. **Japanese brands**, by contrast, skew toward **4×4 and light commercial bodies**, driven by manufacturers such as Isuzu and Toyota who cater to agricultural and logistics users in interior and rural areas.

### 6.3 Market Recency and Future Trends

The average registration year chart provides insight into how recently different origin groups have entered the resale cycle. **Chinese brands** have the most recent average registration year at approximately **2021**, reflecting their very recent introduction into the Tunisian market. Indian, Tunisian, and Swedish origins also cluster around **2019 or later**. Korean and Romanian (Dacia) average around **2018**, reflecting modern but established lineups. In contrast, **Japanese, German, and French brands** show older averages near **2015**, a direct consequence of their decades-long presence in the Tunisian new car market and the corresponding depth of their used inventory.

## 7. Price Distribution and Affordability

### 7.1 Price Concentration and Market Segmentation



**Figure 7.** Price distribution and affordability tiers.

The overall price distribution is **right-skewed**, with the most common price range falling between **33,000 and 38,000 TND**. This band, which can be interpreted as the **core of the mass market**, accounts for approximately **11.2% of all transactions**. The **median listing price** is approximately **38,000 TND**, and **75% of all used cars are priced below 79,000 TND**. Frequency falls sharply above this threshold, confirming that the vast majority of market activity is concentrated in what can be described as the accessible-to-mid-range pricing corridor.

Based on the data distribution and domain knowledge, the market can be partitioned into four affordability tiers, as shown in Table 3. The **mid-range tier (20,000–50,000 TND)** accounts for nearly **half of all listings**; the **premium tier (50,000–95,000 TND)** accounts for approximately **one-third**; and the **luxury tier (above 95,000 TND)** accounts for approximately **one-fifth**. The **accessible tier (10,000–20,000 TND)** represents only **5% of listings**. Crucially, the upper boundary of this lowest tier is under significant pressure from general price inflation: cars in this bracket are predominantly old,



mechanically worn, and often structurally unsafe, representing questionable value even at nominally low prices.

**Table 3.** Market segmentation by affordability tier.

| Segment    | Price Range<br>(TND) | Approx. Share |
|------------|----------------------|---------------|
| Accessible | 10,000 – 20,000      | ~5%           |
| Mid-range  | 20,000 – 50,000      | ~48%          |
| Premium    | 50,000 – 95,000      | ~30%          |
| Luxury     | >95,000              | ~17%          |

## 7.2 Affordability Gap and Economic Signals

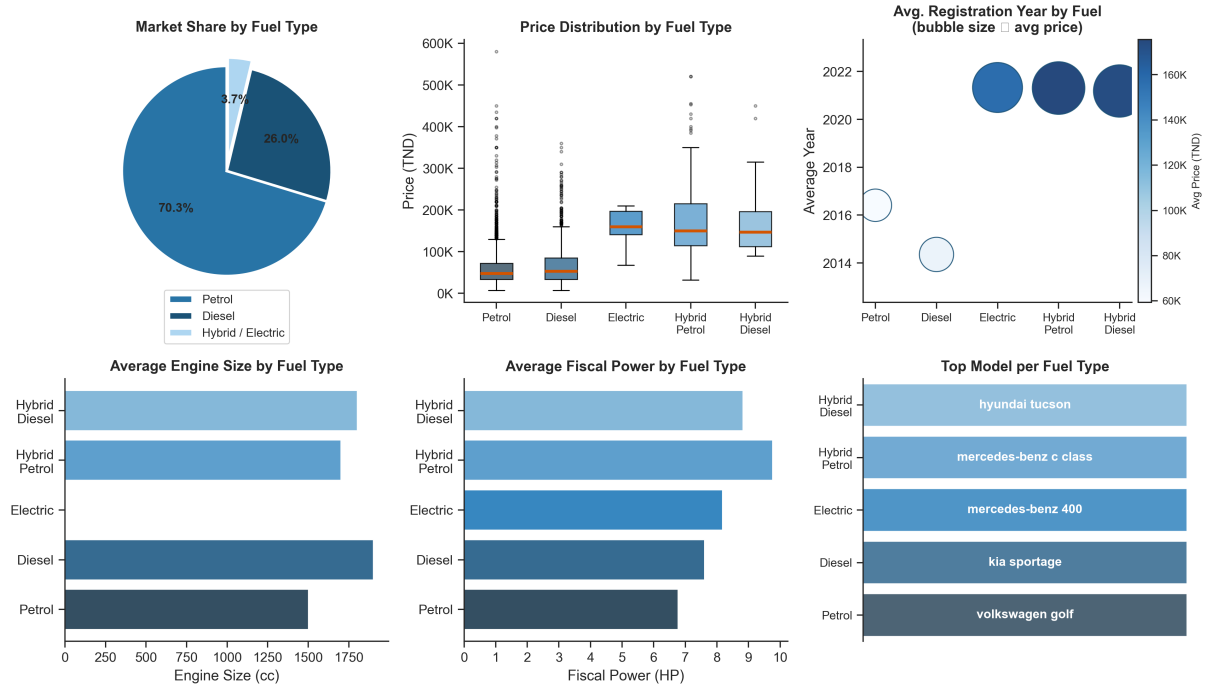
The most significant economic signal in the price data is the **growing gap between median listing price and average national income**. Tunisia's average monthly salary is approximately **1,570 TND** [4]. At a median used car price of approximately **38,000 TND**, a Tunisian worker earning the average salary would need to save their entire income for more than **26 months** — over two years — to afford the median used car without any debt. In practice, financing conditions in Tunisia remain restrictive, and consumer credit penetration in the car market is limited relative to comparable markets. The practical implication is that a large share of car transactions are effected by **long-term savers, loan-dependent buyers, or higher-income individuals** — a profile that does not correspond to the “average” Tunisian wage earner.

This structural imbalance generates a paradox apparent in the cumulative distribution: the market continues to transact at high volumes despite prices that exceed what most buyers can comfortably afford. The explanation lies in the absence of a viable alternative. Tunisia lacks a reliable, extensive, and comfortable public transport network outside Tunis, and even within the capital the network's coverage is incomplete. In a context where private vehicle ownership may be functionally necessary for accessing employment, education, or healthcare, demand is relatively inelastic to price increases. This **captive demand** is a defining structural feature of the Tunisian used car market that shows no near-term signs of moderation.

## 8. Fuel Type Economics

## 8.1 Distribution and Market Share

Fuel Type Economics: Distribution & Technical Specifications



**Figure 8.** Fuel type distribution and technical specifications.

The fuel type breakdown is one of the most structurally informative dimensions of the dataset. **Petrol vehicles** account for a dominant **70.3%** of all listings; **diesel vehicles** account for **26%**; and **electric and hybrid vehicles combined represent just 3.8%**. This distribution is not simply a reflection of consumer preference but is actively shaped by fiscal policy. In Tunisia, diesel vehicles face significantly higher import duties and annual tax obligations — sometimes **up to three times higher** than equivalent petrol vehicles [3] — making diesel ownership economically punitive for most buyers. Diesel engines, which deliver their efficiency advantage most clearly at high annual mileage, are therefore increasingly misaligned with the typical Tunisian buyer's profile, where mileage accumulation is moderate.

A breakdown of fuel market share into the key categories is provided in Table 4.

**Table 4.** Fuel type summary: market share, average price, and average registration year.

| Fuel Type                 | Share (%) | Avg. Price<br>(TND) | Avg. Reg. Year |
|---------------------------|-----------|---------------------|----------------|
| Petrol ( <i>essence</i> ) | 70.3      | ~59,400             | ~2016          |
| Diesel                    | 26.0      | ~68,000             | ~2014          |
| Hybrid petrol             | ~2.5      | ~174,000            | ~2021          |
| Hybrid diesel             | <1        | —                   | —              |
| Electric                  | <1        | ~157,000            | ~2021          |

## 8.2 Price Dynamics by Fuel Type

All fuel categories except electric exhibit **right-skewed price distributions**, confirming the mid-range dominance described in the previous section. **Diesel cars average 68,000 TND** versus **59,400 TND for petrol** — a counterintuitive premium that reflects supply constraints rather than intrinsic value. In comparable international markets, used diesel vehicles typically trade at a discount to petrol equivalents of similar specification. In Tunisia, the combination of limited diesel import volumes, the fiscal penalty imposed on diesel ownership (which reduces competition among buyers and caps the pool of potential purchasers), and a residual appreciation for diesel durability among professional and fleet users has produced an inverted pricing dynamic.

Concrete examples underscore the magnitude of this premium. A **Peugeot 308 petrol** with 108,000 km on the odometer lists at approximately **36,000 TND**, while the equivalent **diesel version** of the same model commands approximately **55,000 TND** — a premium of more than 50%. Similarly, a **Renault Clio V petrol** lists near **44,000 TND**, versus approximately **46,000 TND** for its diesel variant. Hybrid vehicles show the highest average prices (approximately **174,000 TND**), predominantly because the hybrid segment is currently confined to premium, recent SUV models. Electric vehicles, though representing less than 1% of used market listings, exhibit a **left-skewed price distribution**, with prices concentrated at the upper end of the distribution at an average of approximately **157,000 TND**.

## 8.3 Electrification Trends

The emergence of dedicated electric models at accessible price points signals the beginning of a meaningful structural shift. The **Avantier Commuter** (approximately **45,000 TND**) and the **Dongfeng Box** (approximately **49,000 TND**) represent the vanguard of affordably-priced electric options entering the used market. Their appearance in listings is evidence that a market for second-hand electric vehicles is forming at price levels that could, in principle, reach the mid-range tier within a few years. The average registration year for both electric and hybrid vehicles is **2021**, compared to **2016 for petrol**

and **2014 for diesel** vehicles, confirming that the electrified segment consists almost entirely of recent, first-generation market entrants. Whether electrification accelerates will depend significantly on the development of charging infrastructure, on the evolution of import duties applied to electric vehicles, and on battery replacement cost transparency.

#### **8.4 Engine Size and Fiscal Power by Fuel Type**

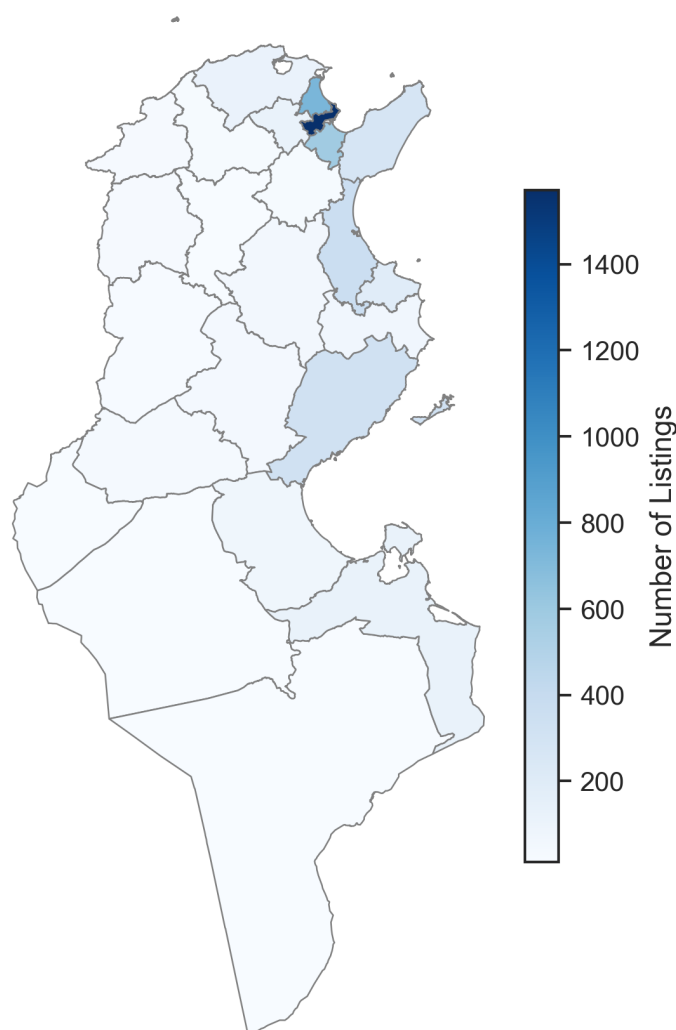
Engine characteristics closely mirror the underlying fiscal and usage logic. Diesel vehicles average approximately **2,000 cc and 8 fiscal horsepower (HP)**; petrol vehicles average **1,500 cc and 7 fiscal HP**; hybrid vehicles average **1,700 cc and 9–10 fiscal HP**, consistent with their SUV-heavy composition; and electric vehicles, despite having no combustion engine, are nevertheless taxed at **8 fiscal HP** — a quirk of Tunisia's taxation framework that treats electric vehicles no more favourably than internal combustion equivalents. This structural rigidity in the tax system represents a meaningful barrier to the acceleration of electric vehicle adoption and stands in marked contrast to the tax incentive regimes adopted by comparable emerging markets and European countries.

### **9. Economic Insights, Transaction Density, and Purchasing Power**

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### 9.1 Transaction Density and Urban Concentration

#### Used Car Listing Frequency by Governorate (Tunisia, 2025)



**Figure 9.** Used car listing frequency by governorate (2025).

The transaction density map confirms that the Tunisian used car market is, in geographic terms, a **highly concentrated market**. **Grand Tunis** accounts for nearly **one-third of all transactions**, a concentration partly explained by the presence of *Souk Lkraheb*, the country's largest weekly automotive marketplace, which acts as a national price-discovery mechanism and attracts buyers and sellers from across the country. Beyond the capital, the three major coastal hubs of **Sousse**, **Sfax**, and **Nabeul** collectively record between **274 and 365 listings each**, representing approximately **one-fifth of the national total**.

combined, with Sousse leading among them.

Smaller coastal cities such as **Monastir** and **Mahdia** record significantly lower volumes. In Mahdia in particular, with only approximately **67 listings**, the market's limited depth can be attributed to smaller population size, lower per-capita economic output, and different mobility cultures: scooters are the dominant transport mode in Mahdia, reflecting the city's compact urban geography, lower wage levels, and shorter average commuting distances. The implication is that the car market in these microenvironments is qualitatively different in character — a market of necessity and occasional second-hand acquisition rather than a dynamic resale ecosystem.

## 9.2 Correlation Between Transaction Volume and Economic Activity

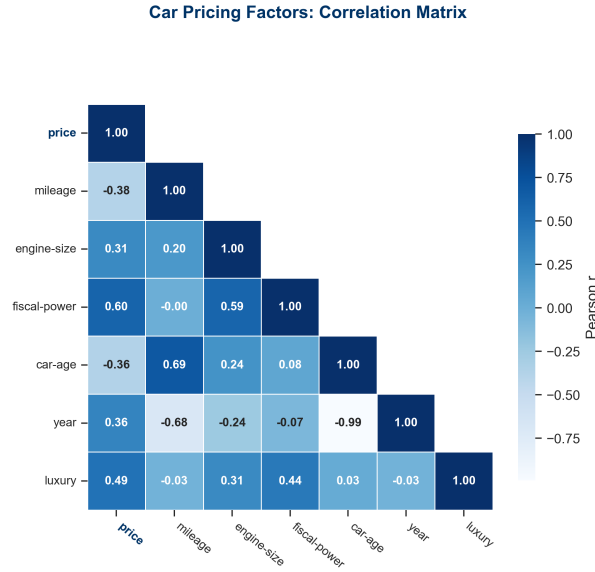
The correlation between listing volume and regional economic activity is consistent and clear throughout the dataset. High-frequency cities correspond uniformly to **high employment rates, higher urbanisation, and stronger transportation demand**. The capital-coastal concentration of transactions is also a concentration of effective market liquidity — these are the markets where prices are set and where the matching of buyers and sellers occurs efficiently. Interior and rural governorates, in contrast, function as **thin secondary markets** where supply is limited, price discovery is imprecise, and transaction costs (including the cost of travel to inspect vehicles) are disproportionately high relative to transaction value.

This spatial structure has practical consequences for equity and access. A buyer in Kasserine seeking a used vehicle has access to a fraction of the inventory available to a buyer in Tunis, must travel further to inspect and complete a purchase, and has fewer competitors for any given listing — conditions that may in practice produce less efficient purchases, both in price and quality terms. Addressing the dual problem of thin market liquidity in interior regions and inadequate public transport infrastructure represents one of the more tractable policy challenges latent in this dataset.

# 10. Market Structure and Pricing Determinants

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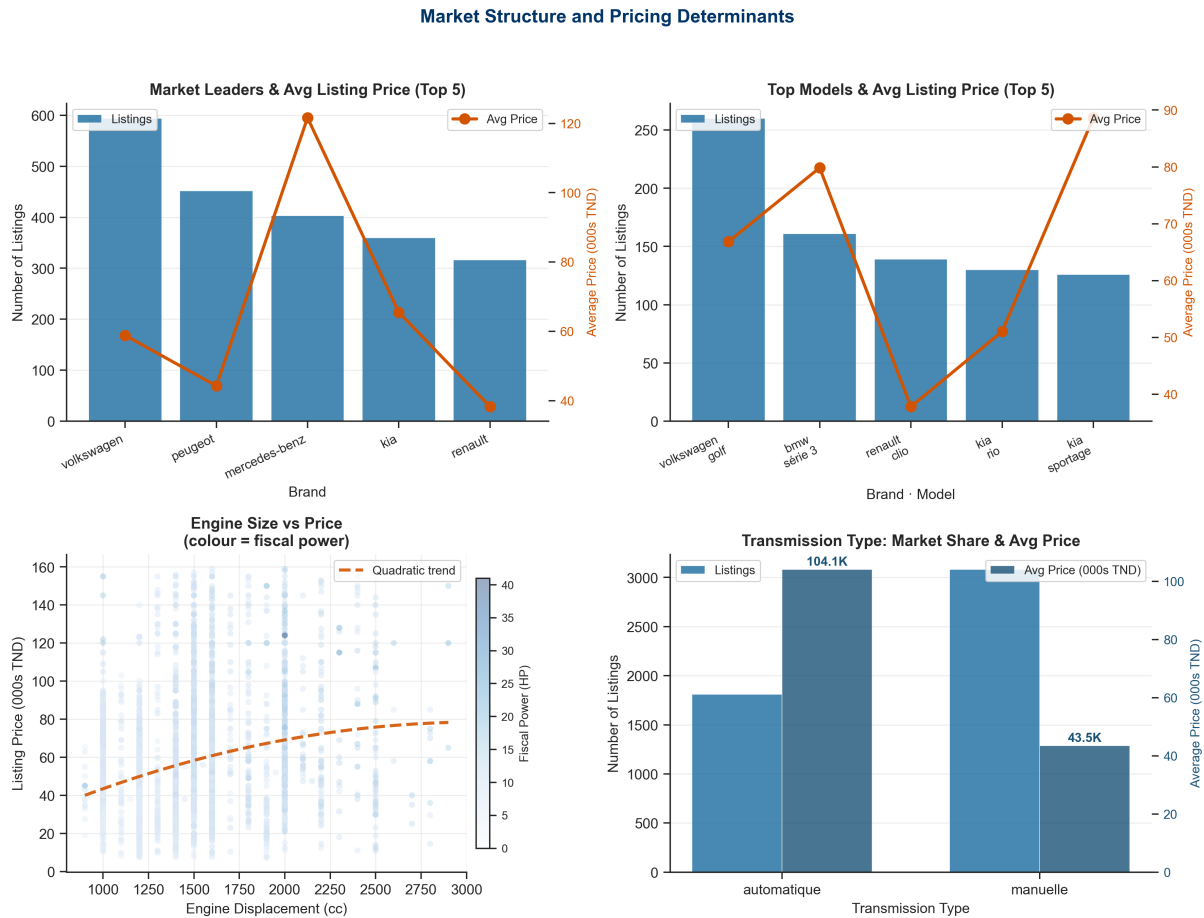
## 10.1 Correlation Analysis



**Figure 10.** Correlation heatmap of numerical features.

The correlation matrix yields four principal findings. First, **fiscal power** is the strongest individual predictor of listing price, with a Pearson correlation coefficient of  $r = 0.60$ . This reflects both the mechanical reality that more powerful vehicles command higher prices and the taxation logic in which fiscal power directly determines annual vehicle tax liability, making high-fiscal-power vehicles more expensive to own as well as to purchase. Second, **manufacturing year** ( $r = 0.36$ ) and **engine size** ( $r = 0.31$ ) are moderate positive predictors, capturing the natural premium on newer and larger-engined vehicles. Third, **mileage** carries a moderate **negative correlation** ( $r = -0.38$ ) with price, as expected. Fourth, the remaining correlations among numerical features are relatively weak, suggesting that no single feature beyond fiscal power dominates the price signal and that a multivariate model would be needed to capture the full complexity of pricing.

## 10.2 Market Leaders: Brand and Model Pricing Position



**Figure 11.** Market structure and pricing determinants.

Among the top five brands by listing count, **Volkswagen** leads both in volume and price, with Peugeot and Renault following in volume at lower price points (approximately **40,000 TND**), and Kia occupying a mid-volume, mid-premium position at approximately **66,000 TND**. **Mercedes-Benz** stands apart as a premium outlier within the top group, with an average listing price of **122,000 TND** despite its relatively modest listing count compared to generalist brands — a dynamic that reflects its exclusive luxury positioning and the narrow demographic of buyers it attracts.

## 10.3 Engine Specifications and Price

The scatter plot of engine size against listing price reveals a mass concentration of vehicles in the **1,000–1,600 cc** range, with a pronounced peak around **1,200 cc**. Vehicles with engines above **2,000 cc** appear at meaningfully lower densities. The **weak positive non-linear relationship** between engine size and price confirms that engine displacement is not a primary standalone pricing driver: the same engine size can correspond to a very wide range of listing prices depending on brand, age, mileage, and fiscal power. Most vehicles in the dataset carry **7–8 fiscal HP**, a range that minimises annual tax liability



and aligns with the typical 1.2–1.6-litre petrol engine.

#### 10.4 Transmission Type and Market Implications

**Table 5.** Transmission type comparison: listing count, average price, and average registration year.

| Transmission | Listing Count | Avg. Price<br>(TND) | Avg. Reg.<br>Year |
|--------------|---------------|---------------------|-------------------|
| Manual       | ~60%          | ~43,500             | ~2015             |
| Automatic    | ~40%          | ~104,000            | ~2018             |

Manual transmission vehicles account for approximately **60% of all listings** at an average price of **43,500 TND**. Automatic vehicles, at **40%** of listings, command an average price of **104,000 TND** — more than twice the manual average. This premium does not solely reflect a consumer preference for automatic transmissions per se; rather, it reflects the fact that automatic transmissions are overwhelmingly associated with **premium and luxury segment vehicles** (Mercedes-Benz, BMW, Audi, upmarket Korean SUVs) that carry high prices for multiple compounding reasons. The average registration year of automatic-transmission vehicles (**2018**) is meaningfully more recent than that of manual vehicles (**2015**), consistent with the association of automatic gearboxes with newer, higher-end models.

### 11. Consumer Behaviour Profile

#### 11.1 The Typical Tunisian Used Car Buyer

Drawing together the various analyses presented in this report, a coherent profile of the typical Tunisian used car buyer emerges from the data. This buyer is most likely resident in **Tunis, Sousse, or Sfax**; is seeking a vehicle in the **mid-range price bracket (20,000–50,000 TND)** with a **petrol engine** of approximately **1.2 to 1.6 litres**; prefers a **city car or compact body style**; and accepts a vehicle **4–7 years old** with odometer readings in the range of **75,000–150,000 km**. The most likely brands of interest are **Renault, Peugeot, Volkswagen, or Kia**; the most likely specific models are the **Renault Clio, Kia Rio, or Volkswagen Polo/Golf**. The typical transaction is conducted on a **manual-gearbox vehicle**, requiring full payment or short-term savings rather than structured financing.

This profile reflects deep economic constraints. The vehicle of choice is defined primarily by what the buyer can afford, not by what the buyer would prefer in an unconstrained choice setting. This is confirmed by the fact that luxury and premium segments together account for nearly **one-fifth of listing volume** despite representing a consumer segment that, by income distribution, should be far smaller. The concentration of luxury listings

in Tunis and the coastal strip confirms that this segment does not represent widespread aspiration translated into purchase; it is a genuinely distinct sub-market serving a narrow slice of the population.

### 11.2 Shifting Behaviour: Shorter Holding Cycles and the Car as an Asset

One of the most important behavioural trends observable in this dataset is the **shortening of vehicle holding periods**. The clustering of listings in the 2.7–6-year age bracket (approximately 40% of all listings) indicates that Tunisian car owners are reselling their vehicles significantly earlier than was typical a decade ago. Several interconnected forces drive this shift.

First, the **rapid inflation of used car prices** has made early resale economically rewarding: a buyer who purchased in 2019 and sells in 2025 may recover not only their original capital but realise a real gain after accounting for depreciation. The car has, in effect, transitioned from a depreciating consumer good to a **partial inflation hedge** for many middle-class households. Second, the growth of online marketplaces has **reduced transaction costs** — both the effort of finding a buyer and the uncertainty around price-setting — making early resale more practical than it once was. Third, the availability of newer, better-equipped models at competitive prices (driven partly by Chinese entrants and partly by dealer competition) has increased the desirability of model replacement, while the high resale value of current holdings has reduced its financial cost.

## 12. Conclusion

Tunisia's used car market in 2025 presents a portrait of a sector under sustained structural pressure, shaped in roughly equal measure by the residual effects of historical shocks, the persistent constraints of a limited-income economy, and the early signals of a technological and behavioural transition. The market is not a simple or static entity: it is a layered system in which a mass-market segment driven by economic necessity coexists with a niche luxury segment driven by discretionary wealth, and in which the geographic and demographic concentration of purchasing power produces persistent spatial inequalities in access, liquidity, and pricing.

At the level of market structure, the **dominance of European manufacturers** — and of German brands in particular — reflects historical import patterns and established dealer networks more than any recent shift in consumer sentiment. This dominance is, however, showing early signs of erosion: Chinese manufacturers, currently representing approximately 4–5% of listings, are entering the market at both ends of the value spectrum. At the affordable end, brands such as *Dongfeng* and *Chery* offer well-equipped city cars at prices competitive with established French models. At the mid-premium end, brands such as *Haval*, *MG*, and *BYD* are targeting segments previously dominated by Korean and German manufacturers. As these vehicles age into the used market over the next

five to ten years, their share of secondary market listings is likely to grow substantially, challenging the current market hierarchy.

The **affordability crisis** documented in this report deserves particular emphasis. At a median listing price of approximately 38,000 TND — equivalent to over 26 months of average salary — the used car market is, for a large proportion of Tunisian households, accessible only through prolonged saving, informal credit arrangements, or significant financial sacrifice. The disappearance of the accessible tier (10,000–20,000 TND) as price inflation erodes it from above is not merely a statistical observation: it represents the effective exclusion of a meaningful share of the population from legitimate vehicle ownership. This exclusion is compounded by the absence of a reliable and comprehensive public transport alternative, which creates a condition of **forced consumption**: households must acquire vehicles they cannot easily afford because the alternative — forgoing personal mobility — is functionally untenable in the context of Tunisia's urban geography and employment structure.

On the **economic signal** dimension, the post-2020 exponential price acceleration is one of the clearest manifestations in any consumer goods market of the economic stresses that have characterised Tunisia in recent years: currency depreciation, import constraints, supply chain disruptions, and generalised inflation. The used car price series functions, in this light, as a real-time barometer of household economic pressure and a leading indicator of the affordability of durable goods more broadly. Policymakers monitoring the health of household finances would do well to track used car price indices alongside traditional economic indicators.

Looking ahead, the **electric and hybrid vehicle segment** — currently representing just 3.8% of listings — is the most consequential unknown in the medium-term trajectory of the market. The barriers to faster electrification are not primarily on the demand side: Tunisian consumers have demonstrated willingness to adopt new technologies when price and functionality are competitive. The barriers are structural: the taxation framework treats electric vehicles no more favourably than combustion equivalents, charging infrastructure outside of Tunis is sparse and unreliable, and there is limited transparency around battery depreciation and replacement costs for used electric vehicles. Addressing these barriers — through tax reform, infrastructure investment, and consumer information — would accelerate the electrification transition and simultaneously reduce the fuel cost burden that falls most heavily on lower-income vehicle owners who lack the capital to access premium fuel-efficient models. The data in this report suggest that the Tunisian used car market is primed for transformation; the pace and character of that transformation will be determined largely by policy decisions made in the next three to five years.

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